

Laboratory Exercise #2: Website Evaluation and Redesign

CMSC 3 – Introduction to Web Design

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GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS:

1. Read and follow all the instructions and steps provided in this laboratory exercise.
2. **Read first the learning materials before doing this activity.** Relate your observations, design decisions, and answers to the web design principles and standards discussed in the learning materials.
3. For the redesign activity, you may use **Figma, Canva or another appropriate web design/prototyping tool.**
4. Your redesigned webpage should address the usability and design problems you identified from the original website.
5. Make sure that all required screenshots, designs, explanations, and answers are included in your submission.
6. If you use Figma, include the **Figma link in your output file** and make sure that the file can be accessed and viewed by your instructor.
7. Submit your completed laboratory exercise according to the required file format and naming convention specified by your instructor.

ACTIVITY: WEBSITE EVALUATION AND REDESIGN

In this activity, you will act as a web designer tasked with evaluating and improving an existing website interface. You will first examine the website to identify problems that may affect its usability, accessibility, user experience, visual organization, and overall effectiveness. You will then use your observations to create a redesigned version of the **website's homepage**.

Your redesign should demonstrate your understanding and application of the following web design principles:

- User-Centric Design
- Usability and User Experience (UX)
- Responsive Design
- Mobile-First Approach
- Accessibility
- Content Quality

- Visual Hierarchy
- Design Consistency
- Performance
- Security and Privacy
- Cross-Browser Compatibility
- Other relevant web design principles discussed.

STEP 1: Select a Website

You may use:

Option A: The website evaluated in Laboratory 1.

Option B: A different website.

STEP 2: Evaluate the Existing Website

Before creating your redesign, carefully examine the selected website. Identify the major design and usability problems that may prevent users from effectively accomplishing their goals.

Guide questions:

- What makes the website difficult to use?
- What information is difficult to find?
- What design elements create confusion?
- Are there accessibility issues?
- Are the typography, colors, spacing, and other visual elements consistent?
- Are important actions or information easy to identify?
- Are there unnecessary elements that could be removed or simplified?

STEP 3: Plan Your Redesign

Before creating the final design, determine the following:

1. Website name?
2. What is the primary purpose of the website?
3. Who are the primary users?
4. Based on your evaluation, identify the three most important improvements you will make.

STEP 4: Create the Redesigned Homepage

Using Figma or another web design/prototyping tool, create an improved version of the website's homepage. Your design should include **two responsive versions**:

- **Mobile Design**
- **Desktop Design**

Your redesign should maintain the website's primary purpose and intended users while addressing the problems you identified in Step 2.

You may modify the following:

- Page layout
- Navigation
- Typography
- Color scheme
- Spacing
- Images
- Buttons
- Content arrangement
- Visual hierarchy
- Calls-to-action
- Forms
- Footer
- Other interface element

STEP 5: Before-and-After Comparison

Present the original and redesigned versions of the homepage.

Attach a screenshot of the original homepage and your redesigned homepage.

STEP 6: Reflection

Answer the following questions:

1. What was the most important problem you discovered while evaluating the website? Why?
2. Which web design principle had the greatest influence on your redesign? Explain.
3. What was the most difficult design decision you made? Why?
4. Is a visually attractive website automatically a good website? Explain your answer.
5. If you were given more time to improve your design, what would you change and why?